

DoorMate — Site Evaluation

Old Site Audit + Bible Review — Verdict on Every Element — Build Blueprint

Purpose: This is not a copy of the old site. It is a judgement on what worked, what did not, and what today's technology adds. Every decision here drives the Claude Code build.

SITE-WIDE ELEMENTS

Header Bar (phone, email, login, basket, search)

KEEP — Phone number in header — first thing a confused customer needs. Keep on new site.

KEEP — Search bar — customers use it. Keep, wire to product search on new site.

KEEP — Basket in header — essential once Stripe is wired in. Add with basket icon when checkout is live.

DROP — Log In link — no account system on new site yet. Drop until needed.

Navigation

KEEP — Gold nav bar, navy text, dropdown on Home — this is the DoorMate brand. Keep exactly.

KEEP — All main category links — Doors | Barn Door Hardware | Pocket Door Kits | Internal | External | Gallery | Shop — these are right.

IMPROVE — Add Shop link to flat nav — accessories are buried. New site gives Shop a top-level flat link.

DROP — Shop By Brand as a nav item — it adds a click without adding value. Brand pages sit under their product category.

Social Media Bar

KEEP — Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, YouTube, Pinterest, Houzz — all carry to new site.

DROP — Twitter/X — dead embed on old site, low value for DoorMate's customer base.

DROP — Mailchimp subscribe link — BANNED.

DROP — Snapchat — dead.

Fix Pinterest URL typo (pintrest → pinterest) on new site.

Footer

KEEP — Phone, email, workshop address, WhatsApp number — all must be in footer.

KEEP — Footer nav links — give customers a second chance to find what they need.

IMPROVE — Update copyright from 2018 to current year — small detail but builds trust.

KEEP — Social media icons in footer — secondary placement, keeps the page clean.

Live Chat / Chatbot

IMPROVE — Old site has Tawk.to. It works but has no product knowledge. New site replaces it with the DoorMate chatbot — 10 years of knowledge, API-connected, briefcase sales approach baked in. This is a major upgrade and must be live on every product page from day one.

HOMEPAGE

Hero Carousel

KEEP — Text-led product announcement slides — this is the right approach. A customer sitting still for 30 seconds learns what DoorMate sells and where to click. Silent photo carousels sell nothing.

KEEP — Gold and navy slide backgrounds — on-brand, high contrast, readable.

KEEP — Circular installation photos on right side of each slide — shows real work without being the whole story.

KEEP — CTA on every slide — 'Click Here To Find Out More' — every slide is a door into the site.

IMPROVE — New site carousel must match this structure exactly. Current build has fixed headline + silent images — rebuild required. 5 confirmed slides: External Sliding Kits | Internal Sliding Kits | Handmade Barn Doors | Channel 4 | Pocket Door Kits.

The Channel 4 slide is slide 4 on the old site — confirmed from live site. Keep it. It is the strongest trust signal DoorMate has.

Reviews — Houzz Widget

KEEP — Houzz widget on homepage — 5-star reviews visible immediately. This is conversion gold. Keep it prominent, above the fold, on the left of the Who We Are section.

IMPROVE — Add Google (4.8★) and Trustpilot (4.5★) alongside Houzz. Old site only has Houzz on homepage. New site shows all three platforms in the trust strip.

6 Category Tile Links

KEEP — 6 tiles linking to main product categories — customers get in fast. Right approach.

IMPROVE — Old site tile order: Sliding Barn Door Hardware | Pocket Doors | Gallery | Our Reviews | Handmade Barn Doors | Pocket Door Kits. New site order: Doors | Pocket Door Kits | Barn Door Hardware | Internal Kits | External Kits | Shop. This is better — leads with what sells most.

Brand Positioning Copy

KEEP — 'THE UK'S LEADING SLIDING DOOR SPECIALISTS' — correct headline. Already on new site.

KEEP — 'We Are Manufacturers, Suppliers and Installers of Quality Door Products' — gold line. Keep.

KEEP — 'Barn Door Hardware | Pocket Door Kits | Internal and External Sliding Systems' — tells Google and customers exactly what DoorMate does. Keep as sub-line.

Pocket Door Brand Logos

KEEP — Coburn, Eclisse, Rocket, Barrier logos as trust signals — 'we stock the major brands'. Must appear on pocket door landing page and homepage. Not on old homepage but should be.

'Don't Accept Cheap Imitations' Section

KEEP — This is Terry's sales voice at its sharpest. Specific, credible, rooted in real problems. Carries straight to new site homepage. No competitor has the credibility to write this copy.

'Every Design Made to Order in Cardiff' Section

KEEP — The workshop, the bespoke process, the invite to visit. This is what separates DoorMate from every warehouse operation. Keep on new site — moves to the About / Our Story section.

Twitter Feed Embed

DROP — Dead on old site. Remove entirely from new site.

BARN DOOR HARDWARE

Category Landing Page

KEEP — All 6 systems on one page with prices and BUY NOW — clean, direct, right.

KEEP — 'UK Manufactured' sub-label on every product tile — one line that does real work.

KEEP — Channel 4 mention as credibility badge in context — right place for it (not as the headline).

KEEP — Intro copy: Cardiff workshop since 2009, spec request sheet, bespoke to your project. All carry.

Individual Product Pages — What Works On Every One

KEEP — 'From £X.XX — BUY NOW' format — non-negotiable. Must be above fold on every page.

KEEP — Star ratings displayed — social proof even without a count.

KEEP — 'Bespoke to Your Project' as a sub-label — differentiates from every off-the-shelf competitor.

KEEP — Spec request process described — 'every order followed up with a spec request sheet' — no importer does this.

KEEP — What's included list — all components UK-sourced, fixing pack, fitting instructions, video link, telephone support. This is reassuring and comprehensive.

KEEP — RAL colour option — shows genuine customisation capability.

KEEP — Delivery note for offshore addresses — honest and reduces returns disputes.

Sizing Formulas (Gainesville, Brooklyn)

KEEP — Track sizing formula with worked example — 'track = 2x door width, 760mm opening = 840mm door = 1700mm track'. This answers the #1 customer question. Remove the fear of ordering wrong. Must be on every hardware product page.

Kit Contents Lists (Covington, Augusta)

KEEP — Full kit contents — customers know exactly what arrives. Reduces complaints, reduces returns. Carry to every product page.

Low Headroom Copy (Detroit, Baltimore)

KEEP — 'Not enough headroom? The Detroit is your answer' — problem/solution framing. 90mm minimum is specific and searchable. This is the headline, not an afterthought.

KEEP — 'The low headroom version of the Brooklyn' for Baltimore — makes the choice simple. Exact phrasing.

Technical Stuff Page

KEEP — Headroom requirements, floor guide comparison, door design options — customers self-serve on sizing. Converts.

IMPROVE — Old site is image-heavy, text-thin. New site presents this as proper text content for SEO. Detroit and Baltimore headroom specs were missing from old page — add them.

Barn Door FAQ — 20 Questions

KEEP — All 20 questions — exact content that Google ranks and AI assistants cite. Must carry to new site as visible static text with FAQPage Schema.org markup.

IMPROVE — Add Detroit and Baltimore specific questions ('What is the minimum headroom for the Detroit?') — not on old site.

POCKET DOOR KITS

Category Landing

KEEP — 'The Widest Choice of Pocket Door Kits' — strong positioning claim. DoorMate stocks all major brands. Keep.

KEEP — Brand logo tiles: Rocket, Eclisse, Coburn, Barrier — trust signal. Keep.

IMPROVE — Old landing has no prices and no intro copy. New site adds both — what a pocket door kit is, why DoorMate is the right place to buy.

Rocket Page

KEEP — 12-year warranty — strongest claim in the category. Must be the HEADLINE on the Rocket page, not buried in copy.

KEEP — 'Metal frame structural integrity' — functional benefit. Keep.

KEEP — Fire rated option — important for building regs. Keep.

KEEP — Accessories cross-sell — Pocket Door Privacy Lock £29.94 on this page. Confirmed cross-sell.

IMPROVE — Add prices to all products. Old site has 'Order Here' links but no prices shown. New site shows prices.

Eclisse Page

KEEP — 'Designed with the installer in mind' — specific trade buyer positioning.

KEEP — 'No cutting required — fits standard UK door sizes' — genuine differentiator from Coburn Hideaway.

KEEP — Syntesis flush system as premium tier — upsell opportunity.

Coburn Page

KEEP — Three system types clearly explained (Hideaway, Easyslide, Insedor) — different customers need different systems.

KEEP — 'No tools required / click and snap' for Easyslide — strong DIY appeal.

KEEP — Glass door option — niche but converts.

Barrier Page

KEEP — Full spec table (weight, width, thickness, height for PD1 and PD2) — most detailed page on old site, most useful for customers with non-standard doors.

KEEP — 'Not limited to standard UK door sizes' — genuine differentiator from Eclisse and Rocket.

KEEP — Full kit contents list — detailed and reassuring.

PRICE CHECK NEEDED before new site build: PD1 old site £160 vs bible £139. PD2 old site £186 vs bible £154. Use the correct current price only.

Installation Enquiry — 5-Step Form Wizard

KEEP — Multi-step wizard is best practice. Qualifies the customer before they call Terry. Low abandonment vs a single long form.

IMPROVE — Old site: only accessible from Pocket Door Kits nav. New site: linked from every product page AND Services page.

Pocket Door FAQ — 11 Questions

KEEP — All 11 questions. Max weight (60kg), wall thickness specs, 12-year warranty reiteration — all carry with FAQPage Schema.org markup.

IMPROVE — Add Barrier, Eclipse, and Coburn specific questions. Old FAQ only covers Rocket.

Pocket Door Tech Info

KEEP — Advantages list: pre-cut steel, no floor track, continues floor surface through, door brake, sealed-for-life bearings. This IS the sales copy for pocket door kits — use it on the landing page.

KEEP — 6-size selection table — removes guesswork.

KEEP — Rocket installation video embed.

KEEP — Lining guide — 4 steps. Shows depth of support no competitor matches.

EXTERNAL SLIDING DOOR KITS

Category Landing

KEEP — Weight range (75kg to 200kg) stated upfront — customers immediately know if it suits their door.

KEEP — 'Galvanised, weather-resistant' — specific claims. Not just 'heavy duty'.

KEEP — 'From a single garden door to a large agricultural opening' — range of use cases.

KEEP — ENQUIRE NOW for Bi-Passing and Wrap Around kits — these are higher value, bespoke jobs. Right CTA.

Single and Bi-Parting Sub-Pages

KEEP — BS EN 10346 standard cited — credibility for trade buyers.

KEEP — Applications list (garages, stables, industrial) — sets context.

KEEP — 'Choose by door weight' selection method — DM-75/100/150/200 naming explained.

KEEP — All four variants with prices and BUY NOW.

IMPROVE — New site should explain what DM-75/100/150/200 means — the kg capacity — not just the model number.

INTERNAL SLIDING DOOR KITS

Category Landing

KEEP — '100,000 cycles tested' — specific engineering claim. Keep.

KEEP — 'Whisper-quiet' — tangible benefit.

IMPROVE — Old site has 3 tiles and generic AI copy. New site has 4 tiles (Timber | Stainless | Glass | Minimalist — confirmed 26 May 2026) and Terry's voice.

DROP — 'Maximise your interior space' / 'room real estate' / 'elevate your space' — generic AI language. None of it. Terry's words only.

Glass Door Kits Sub-Page

KEEP — Named systems (Flexiglas 50, Straightaway G80, Flexiglas 120, G130) with weight specs — customers self-select by door weight.

KEEP — 'No cut-outs required in the glass' — this is a genuine customer concern and a real differentiator.

Prices not confirmed anywhere for these products. Terry to confirm before product pages built.

DOORS

Handmade Barn Doors

KEEP — 'From £527.00' price anchor — BUY NOW — star ratings. Format is right.

KEEP — Lead time note — sets expectations honestly, reduces post-purchase dissatisfaction.

KEEP — 'Handmade to Your Exact Measurements' sub-label.

IMPROVE — Old site missing: pine vs oak distinction (oak NOT made in Cardiff), oak POA, door design options (V-Brace, Z-Brace, Ledge and Brace, Glazed panel). New site adds all of these.

Pocket Doors Sub-Page

KEEP — 'Only UK Manufacturer of Mirror Pocket Doors' — strongest specific claim on the whole site. Front and centre.

KEEP — Price anchors for both products.

IMPROVE — Old site missing soft close recommendation for mirror doors (25kg before mirror added — always recommend 30-45kg soft close). Add on new site.

Internal Doors

KEEP — Price anchor (£62.85), range breadth ('Over 60 Doors Across 12 Ranges').

IMPROVE — Old site has no cross-sell to pocket door kits. A customer buying an internal door almost certainly needs a pocket door kit or sliding kit. New site puts that cross-sell on this page.

SHOP AND ACCESSORIES

Shop Landing

DROP — Old site shop landing is empty — shows nothing. Customers see a blank page and leave.

KEEP — New site shop opens immediately to 4 category tiles: Pull Handles | Hardware Components | Locks | Brackets.

POPULAR and NEW Badges

KEEP — These are proven conversion tools. Social proof (POPULAR) and novelty (NEW/JUST IN). Must carry to new site on every shop item.

Hardware Components — 21 Products

KEEP — All 21 items. Repeat-purchase revenue and spare parts for existing customers. Floor guides, L-stops, soft close units, wheels — these generate margin with zero acquisition cost.

KEEP — Cross-sell floor guides and handles on every barn door hardware product page ('Frequently Bought Together').

Pull Handles — 19 Products

KEEP — All 19 handles. DM1 (£20) and DM2 (£25) are the primary cross-sell on every barn door hardware page.

KEEP — POPULAR badges on best-sellers.

Locks — 6 Products

KEEP — Pocket Door Privacy Lock (£29.94) — explicit cross-sell on EVERY pocket door product page (confirmed in bible). HIGH priority.

KEEP — Cabin hooks and latch locks for barn door hardware pages.

Shelf and Brackets — 4 Products

KEEP — Easy upsell. Low price. Brand-consistent naming. Keep.

GALLERY

150+ Installation Photos

KEEP — Volume of proof is the point. 150+ real installations show years of real work. All carry to new site.

KEEP — Named alt text on every image — small SEO win, already done on old site.

IMPROVE — Old gallery is almost entirely barn door hardware. New site gallery adds pocket door and sliding kit installations when photos are available.

IMPROVE — Filter by product type — old site has no filter. New site lets customers find their system.

DROP — Right-click instruction — outdated.

DROP — 'Upcycled materials' in intro — not accurate for all products.

SUPPORT AND INFO PAGES

Services Page

KEEP — Free on-site survey as the primary CTA — removes financial risk from first contact. This is the right conversion approach for a high-value bespoke product.

KEEP — Products installed list: all 5 categories.

KEEP — 'Nationwide Coming Soon' for pocket doors.

KEEP — Link to installation enquiry form.

DROP — 'Cardiff's elegant residences, the prestigious Vale of Glamorgan' — marketing fluff. Not Terry's language. Replace with plain English.

About Us / Our Story

KEEP — Personal story core: Cardiff workshop, garage door background, hands-on expertise, US tour product naming.

KEEP — 'Production updates with photos during manufacture' — unique service promise, no competitor offers this.

KEEP — Spec request process as differentiator.

KEEP — Houzz and Trustpilot as named platforms.

DROP — 'Premier source' and 'eco-friendly / upcycled materials' — outdated 2009 positioning.

The /our-story page (content already written in doormate_website_content.md) supersedes the old About Us entirely. That content is better.

Contact Page

KEEP — Contact form (Name, Email, Telephone, Enquiry), phone, email, address, WhatsApp, map embed.

KEEP — 'Leave us a review' link — encourages post-purchase reviews.

KEEP — All social platform links.

DROP — Snapchat (dead).

Fix Pinterest URL typo.

Trade Page

KEEP — 10% after 3rd purchase, 20% after 10th purchase — clear incentive. Terry to confirm this is still current before publishing.

KEEP — Fitting territory concept — links to Fitters Wanted.

Fitters Wanted

KEEP — Exclusive territory proposition — very compelling for sole traders.

KEEP — '1-2 hours' installation time — attractive for add-on work.

KEEP — Requirements list — fair, specific, sets expectations.

Dropshipping

DROP — Has been 'coming soon' for years. Placeholder pages waste crawl budget. Either launch it with a real plan or remove it entirely. Terry to decide.

News / Blog

KEEP — Blog section essential for SEO and AI citation.

DROP — Existing blog posts — generic AI voice, no DoorMate insight, no CTAs.

KEEP — 3 new content pieces from PART 20 of bible (Our Story, The Truth About Barn Door Hardware, Solving the Warping Door Problem) — these are the first 3 posts on the new site. Terry's voice. Real stories.

How To Order

KEEP — 'Choosing a sliding door system is not something you do every day' — empathetic opening. Right.

KEEP — Binary first question (single/double) — correct, it IS the most common confusion point.

IMPROVE — Extend to cover all product types, not just barn door hardware. This page becomes the pre-cursor to the quote calculator.

WHAT TODAY'S TECHNOLOGY ADDS — THE OLD SITE NEVER HAD ANY OF THIS

Schema.org JSON-LD Structured Data

The old site has zero structured data. This is why Google never shows DoorMate in rich results — no star ratings in search, no prices, no FAQ answers. Every page on the new site needs: Organisation + LocalBusiness in layout, Product + AggregateRating on product pages, FAQPage on FAQ content, BreadcrumbList on categories. This is the single biggest technical gap on the old site.

llms.txt at Root

A plain text file at /llms.txt that tells AI assistants (ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, Gemini) exactly what DoorMate sells, main URLs, prices, and key differentiators. Takes 20 minutes to write. Means DoorMate appears when someone asks an AI 'where can I buy a pocket door kit UK'. Zero cost, high value.

DoorMate Chatbot

Already built. API key exists. Knowledge base in Google Sheet, auto-updating hourly. Briefcase sales approach baked in. This is the after-hours sales person no competitor has. Must be live in the corner of every product page from day one — not 'later'.

Quote Calculators

The How To Order page on the old site does this manually. A v1 calculator (2 questions: opening size, door type → recommended product + price) is better than nothing. Captures the lead whether the customer buys now or not.

Cross-Sell Blocks

The old site has zero cross-sell between categories. A barn door hardware customer never sees floor guides or handles. A pocket door kit customer never sees the Privacy Lock. This is pure margin being left on the table. Every product page on the new site has a 'Frequently Bought Together' section.

Stripe Checkout

Old site uses WebFactory checkout. New site: Card, PayPal, Apple Pay, Google Pay, Klarna/Clearpay. Terry has an existing Stripe account. This is a dedicated session — not part of the homepage build.

Reviews Page

Old site has Houzz on homepage and a Trustpilot link in footer — nothing connecting them. New site has a dedicated /reviews page collecting Google (4.8), Trustpilot (4.5), Houzz (5.0) in one place. AggregateRating structured data so reviews show in Google search results.

Open Graph Meta Tags

Old site has none. Controls how every link looks when shared on Facebook, WhatsApp, LinkedIn. Takes one session to add to layout.jsx and covers the entire site.

BUILD ORDER — FASTEST REVENUE FIRST

Phase 1 — Homepage (in progress). Fix hero carousel to text-led slides. Sign off homepage.

Phase 2 — Schema, llms.txt, Open Graph (one Claude Code session, no new content needed).

Phase 3 — Barn Door Hardware (highest margin, all content exists on old site).

Phase 4 — Pocket Door Kits (highest volume revenue, proven by eBay data).

Phase 5 — External Sliding Kits.

Phase 6 — Shop / Accessories.

Phase 7 — Doors category.

Phase 8 — Internal Sliding Kits (when Terry confirms product weights).

Phase 9 — Content and SEO pages (Reviews, Our Story, Blog, Gallery, How To Order).

Phase 10 — Conversion machinery (Chatbot wired in, Quote Calculators, Stripe checkout).

Phase 11 — Supporting pages (Contact, About, Services, Trade, Fitters Wanted).

Phase 12 — Legacy site 301 redirects on barn-doors.co.uk.

Written 3 June 2026. Based on full audit of barn-doors.co.uk (47 pages) + CLAUDE.md (Project Bible v2 + all session updates). No content invented. All verdicts based on evidence from live site and confirmed session decisions.